system, (size of your operating system + the applications you use) x 4.

Linux on the desktop

This free operating system has stirred up a hornet's nest in the world of computing. Starting out as an operating system for the hardcore techie, Linux has made rapid strides in its ease of usability and is now accepted as a viable replacement to the dominance of Windows. From large corporations to first-time users, Linux is flexible enough to meet the needs of almost everyone. And people have woken up to this fact and are being tempted by the thousands to 'try' out this system. Obviously the easiest way to experience something new is when you're sure that you can revert back to your tried and tested path in case everything doesn't go according to plan. This is where a large hard disc can make a difference—as operating systems move on from single floppy setups to gigabyte installations it's imperative to have a large enough storage solution to accommodate multiple OSes. Linux now comes in a seven CD installation kit along with a plethora of bundled applications requiring more disk space than ever before!

Internet

Windows rewrote the PC story, while the Internet revolutionised the access and sharing of information and data management. Assimilating and accumulating information from all over, the Internet has grown into a huge repository of data. The Internet is a central repository of information, ranging from text to high-end graphics and video—with servers that have petabytes of storage space to host and serve this information. This means larger and more reliable storage. The storage needs for such a distributed and diversified knowledgebase is quite obviously enormous.

Information available on the Internet is distributed across servers over the globe. These servers are powered by the latest storage technologies to serve faster and reliable information to their customers. Storage is very important in mission critical applications where customer data has to be secured, stored, and delivered reliably. From large corporate servers to desktop computers the hard disc is responsible for facilitating the storage and exchange of information and data over this network. Without these storage mediums there would be no Internet so to speak. For example, servers running Web services cannot suffer a downtime. Such businesses need to have a reliable data storage device that must be rugged and robust, work under any conditions, and have a large MTBF (Mean Time Between Failure).

With large-scale enterprises and e-businesses growing exponentially, customers have started demanding faster and more reliable storage facilities in relatively higher capacities. This has led to a new business segment called 'Storage Service providers'. Storage space is rented for personal, commercial, and enterprise usage across the world. This requires faster hard drives that provide worthy

Internet and the Enterprise

Seagate continues its lead in Enterprise Storage by pushing the envelope in both capacity and speed. Seagate's fifth generation of Cheetah products incorporates the best performance and technology in the industry. The fullest line of products in the enterprise market consists of the amazing new 15,000-rpm Cheetah X15 and the 10,000-rpm Cheetah 18XL, Cheetah 36LP/XL and the remarkable Cheetah 73LP. This family of Cheetah drives provides capacities from 9.2 to 73.4 GB in a 3.5–inch form factor for mainstream and high performance users. Interface options include Ultra160 SCSI and the new 2 Gbps fibre channel. Seagate has dramatically improved the Cheetah performance by delivering seek times as fast as 3.9 ms, latencies as low as 2 ms and an increase in data rates of up to 70 per cent over the previous generation.

Cheetah disk drives are perfect for:
- Internet and e–commerce servers
- Data mining and data warehousing
- Mainframes and supercomputers
- Department/Enterprise servers and workstations
- Array storage subsystems
- Transaction processing
- Professional video
- Graphics and medical imaging

Key features and benefits

The fifth generation Seagate team delivers Cheetah products that lead the industry in performance and IOPS (Input/Output Operations Per Second). 10K and 15K RPM spindle speeds provide Cheetah drives faster access to data. The Cheetah X15 has the fastest time to data in the industry with average seek times as low as 3.9 ms and 2 ms average latency!

Seagate's superior Ultra160 SCSI interface provides bus data rates up to 160 MBps, features 'Fairness' technology to eliminate bottlenecks and is backward compatible with previous versions of SCSI. 2 Gbps fibre channel offers extremely fast bus data rates of up to 400 MBps for a dual loop, and supports standard SCSI protocol, allowing easy interface transition. With up to 16 MB of cache, Cheetah products provide high performance in applications such as A/V, CAD, Pre-Press, and Imaging. Seagate's 3D Defense System, the most comprehensive drive protection system in the industry—Drive Defense, Data Defense and Diagnostic Defense—decreases handling damage, protects valuable data and provides alerts for potential problems.

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